सत्यमेव जयते

F. No. 9/7/2026/CD(Cen)-Media

भारत सरकार/Government of India

गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs

भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय

Office of the Registrar General of India & Census Commissioner

जनगणना प्रभाग/Census Division

Janganana Bhawan, 2/A, Mansingh Road, New Delhi-110011

Dated: 13-10-2026

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 – CIRCULAR No. 28

Subject: National/State Publicity and Hyperlocal Outreach Strategy for Phase-II of Census of India 2027 (Population Enumeration) – reg

Preparations for the smooth conduct of the Population Enumeration (PE) phase for the Census of India 2027 are underway across all States/UTs following the successful completion of the Houselisting Operations (HLO). For the successful enumeration in Phase-II, it is crucial that adequate publicity measures, similar to HLO phase are undertaken to raise awareness among people about the importance of Census exercise and its utilities in shaping the nation. Such efforts also establish rapport with people, ensuring a warm and positive reception for enumerators during household visits.

2. The publicity campaign for PE phase will not only inform people about the questions to be canvassed during field visits but will also educate them on accessing and completing the digital Self-Enumeration (SE) module where public can fill their information at the comfort of their residence. Furthermore, the publicity must reassure respondents that all information provided is legally confidential under the Census Act, fostering trust and confidence in the process.

3. To ensure comprehensive 360° media coverage without duplication to the extent possible, a clear segregation of publicity modes has been established across administrative levels:

   i. **ORGI:**

      a. Pan-India mass media campaigns covering national scheduled language newspapers, television commercials, commercial digital cinema theatre screen advertisements, digital media static banners, high-traffic digital app marketing, in-transport audio announcements (airports/railways), SE Tutorial videos, question explainers, Myth Busters, etc. to be undertaken at ORGI through Central Bureau of Communications (CBC).

b. Centralized MyGov competitions, BSNL IVRS & Chatbot platforms, WhatsApp/SMS marketing

c. Republic Day Tableau 2027 (subject to approval of the Ministry of Defence) and Census 2027 Commemorative Postage Stamp launch at New Delhi.

ii. **Directorates of Census Operations (DCOs):** State-specific organic publicity tailored to regional requirements, including digital and static outdoor hoardings, mobile van campaigns, Radio campaigns (AIR/Pvt FM/CRS), social media paid booster campaign (Audio-Visual Creatives), and state celebrity engagements. DCOs may utilize the services of state IPR department/Regional CBC/any agency following the GFR rules and approved rates similar to HLO phase.

iii. Master creatives for the above-mentioned activities undertaken by ORGI and the DCOs shall be developed by ORGI and shared with the DCOs. The DCOs may undertake the necessary translations and language adaptations and may also supplement these creatives/activities, as required, based on their local needs and requirements.

iv. **PCOs & COs (Hyperlocal Outreach):** High visibility district interventions and community level grassroots outreach activities to be executed as per operational guidelines and indicative publicity activities for undertaking hyperlocal & grassroots Publicity by PCOs and COs as enclosed at Annexure-I.

4. The approved financial norms and expenditure ceilings for undertaking hyperlocal publicity at the State/UT level are fixed as follows:

- **Principal Census Officers (PCOs)** (District Collectors / District Magistrates / Municipal Commissioners): **₹1,50,000/-** (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousand only) per PCO.
- **Charge Officers (COs)** (Tehsildars / Block Development Officers / Ward Officers): **₹25,000/-** (Rupees Twenty-Five Thousand only) per Charge.

5. To accommodate wide variations in population density, urban complexity, and difficult geographic terrain, PCOs are authorized to regulate fund distribution among their charges, including diverting underutilized funds from smaller/sparse charges to larger, high-density charges based on verified field requirements.

6. All expenditure shall be incurred strictly in accordance with the provisions of GFR, DFPR, and other applicable rules/instructions issued by the Government of India from time to time.

7. After incurring the expenditure towards the hyperlocal publicity by the State/UT Government, consolidated Utilization Certificates (UCs) shall be obtained as per the applicable procedure.

8. DCOs are advised to maintain effective 24/7 social media monitoring cells to track digital narratives around-the-clock for any adverse comments, false narratives, or local misinterpretations, so that authoritative rebuttals and fact-checks can be published in real time through State/UT machinery.

9. Concerned DCOs shall coordinate proactively with PCOs and COs, provide necessary guidance, mentor field functionaries, and monitor the implementation of hyperlocal activities. DCOs must document all publicity activities, collect representative media clippings and recordings, and submit a comprehensive report on the execution and impact of the campaign in their State/UT once the Population Enumeration exercise concludes.

Narayanm 13/10/2026

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To

The Director of Census Operations (All States/UTs)

Copy to

1. Chief Secretaries, All States/UTs
2. Principal Census Officers (District Collectors / Municipal Commissioners), All Districts/Municipal Corporations (through DCOs of States/UTs)
3. Addl RG / DDG, ORGI HQ
4. All Divisional Heads including Language Division, Kolkata
5. Integrated Finance Division (IFD), Ministry of Home Affairs, New Delhi (through IFA)
6. Guard File

ANNEXURE - I

Guidelines for Hyperlocal Publicity by PCOs and COs

The primary objective of hyperlocal awareness is to build public trust, explain the statutory obligation, and highlight the developmental importance and utility of the Census directly to the public. Ground-level outreach must demystify the questions being asked, guide households on the Self-Enumeration web and mobile module and facilitate smooth cooperation during enumerator field visits. PCOs and COs are equipped to promptly address and counter localized myths, rumors, or misinterpretations by issuing official administrative rebuttals and clarifications whenever necessary.

2. In implementing these initiatives, local authorities may ensure that activities taken up by them are concentrated in their jurisdiction only. It is important to note that hyperlocal activities must avoid the procurement of physical equipment/capital assets with limited utility post-census. Below are some indicative publicity activities that may be undertaken by the PCOs and COs:

A. **Indicative Publicity Activities for Principal Census Officers (PCOs)**
(Financial Ceiling: ₹1,50,000 per PCO)

i. Display of hoardings, standees, and banners across Collectorate premises, Sub-Divisional offices, Police Stations, District/Taluk Hospitals, Central Bus Terminals, and Railway Stations.
ii. Thematic rallies, Census run/marathons, school/college awareness competitions, and cultural melas focused on Census 2027.
iii. Collaboration with district icons, local folk artists, cultural performers, and sports figures for pro-bono endorsements and video appeals via district social media channels.
iv. Official WhatsApp broadcast channels, Collectorate citizen portals, and district administrative social media handles for swift circular dissemination.
v. Public address announcements via municipal solid-waste collection vehicles and local civic utility vehicles.
vi. Display of Census static slides in local cinema halls prior to film screenings.
vii. Any other district specific elements that suit the hyperlocal publicity requirements of the district.
viii. Census Stickers with enumeration dates on household LPG cylinders and utility bills

B. **Indicative Publicity Activities for Charge Officers (COs)**
(Financial Ceiling: ₹25,000 per Charge)

i. Mic-equipped e-rickshaws/autos/small vans/two-wheelers making localized audio announcements in residential lanes regarding Self-Enumeration dates, enumerator visits and highlighting the importance of the Census as a statutory exercise by mentioning its utility for the welfare of the people.
ii. Wall paintings carrying official slogans in local vernacular languages across mandal/tehsil headquarters, village chowks, and prominent crossroads.

iii. Placement of posters and banners at Gram Panchayat Bhawans, Fair Price Shops (Ration Shops), Anganwadi Centres, Primary Health Sub-Centres, and Milk Collection Booths.

iv. Street plays (*Nukkad Nataks*), puppet shows, and folk troupe performances during weekly *haats*, village bazaars, and fairs.

v. Public address announcements at rural markets and transit stands.

vi. Scroll messages, tickers, and spot announcements on local cable TV networks.

vii. Census promotional stickers on registered autorickshaws, shared taxis, and local public transport.

viii. Information sharing through local WhatsApp groups (Resident Welfare Associations, Self-Help Groups, Farmer Producer Organizations).

ix. Utilizing village-level volunteers, ASHA workers, and Anganwadi workers to sensitize communities during regular Gram Sabha, Ward Committee and VHSNC meetings.

x. Any other charge specific elements that suit the hyperlocal publicity requirements of the charge.

3. **Creatives Production Guidelines for both PCOs and COs (Points to Remember)**

i. All creative collateral, local scripts, and publicity material developed by PCOs and COs must strictly comply with the following principles:

ii. Population Census is a Union subject (Article 246) in India and is listed at serial number 69 of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution. The Census Act, 1948, and the Census Rules, 1990, as amended from time to time, form the legal basis for the conduct of the Census in India. All publicity material must remain strictly apolitical. Photographs, names, or depictions of politicians and political figures must not be used under any circumstances.

iii. State Government logos may not be used on the creatives.

iv. Ensure complete visual uniformity across all collateral (content, colour palettes, themes, and formats). Official Census 2027 logos, approved taglines, slogans, and the latest official mascots must be prominently incorporated.

v. Creatives must clearly display the exact timelines and dates for the Self-Enumeration (SE) phase and the Population Enumeration (PE) enumerator field visits.

vi. Whenever territorial or geographic maps (India or States/UTs) are used, ensure only authenticated, legally approved maps are depicted.

vii. Messages assuring the public regarding data security and the legal confidentiality of individual responses must be explicitly integrated.

viii. All print, outdoor, and digital creatives must prominently feature the official Census interactive handles:

   a. **Chatbot Number:** 18001801855
   b. **IVRS Toll-Free Helpline Number:** 1855

ix. Content must be pre-screened to ensure accuracy, sensitivity, and that no controversies or misinterpretations arise from the published material.